

Open-Source Compliance Ladder

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Obligations by licence type

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The Open-Source Compliance Ladder orders open-source obligations by stringency — from permissive notice requirements to strong copyleft — guiding the compliance effort each licence demands.

WHO DEVELOPED IT

A construct from open-source-compliance practice, reflecting work by bodies such as the Linux Foundation's OpenChain project.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

It was developed to help organisations comply with open-source obligations, which scale with licence type and can affect proprietary code.

FIGURE 1 · OPEN-SOURCE COMPLIANCE LADDER

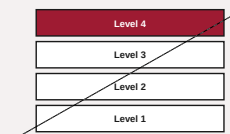


Figure 1. A schematic of the Open-Source Compliance Ladder as applied in BARBM312 (illustrative).

HOW IT IS USED

Each component's licence is placed on the ladder and the corresponding obligations met before distribution.

WHEN IT IS USED

When incorporating open-source AI components into products.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Legal, engineering and compliance teams.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

It clarifies the graduated nature of open-source obligations, helping avoid inadvertent copyleft exposure in AI products.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

IP Protection Portfolio · Slibrary 16

Licensing Models Map · Slibrary 16

Freedom-to-Operate Check · Slibrary 16

AI Output Ownership Flow · Slibrary 16

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

OpenChain Project (2022) ISO/IEC 5230: Open Source Compliance.

Fontana, R. et al. (2021) Open Source Compliance in the Enterprise. Linux Foundation.